

Topic:

Organizational Behavior

- ⇒ Organizational behavior refers to how people act in their workplaces.
- ⇒ Over time, experts in OB have developed different ideas (theories) to understand and explain why people behave the way they do at work.
- ⇒ These theories help project managers lead teams more effectively.

Background Study

- ⇒ The study of organizational behavior began with the work of Frederick Taylor in the late 1800s and early 1900s.
- ⇒ Taylor focused on finding the most efficient way to do physical tasks at work. His main ideas were:
 1. Select the best people for each job.
 2. Teach them the best methods to do the job.
 3. Motivate the best workers by offering rewards.

Staff Selection

- ⇒ Selecting the right candidate/employees can be difficult because it is common to hire someone who looks good on paper but is not best fit for the job.
- ⇒ An eligible candidate may have the right qualifications and experience listed on their resume or CV.
- ⇒ Suitable candidate can actually do the job well.
- ⇒ It's recommended to focus on assessing the candidate's actual skills rather than just their past experience.
- ⇒ If they have small gaps in their abilities, you can train them to improve.

General steps for staff selection

- ⇒ The general steps for staff selection:
 1. Create a job specification -
 - Write down what the job requires.
 2. Create a job holder profile:
 - Describes the type of person who would be good for the job.

3. Obtain applicants:-

- o Look for people interested in the position.

4. Examine CVs

- o Review the candidate's resumes.

5. Conduct tests and interviews:-

- o Evaluate their skills and suitability.

6. Other procedures

- o Complete any additional necessary steps.

Staff Development

⇒ When new people join a team, the team leader needs to carefully plan how to introduce them to the team and the work.

⇒ This process is called induction.

⇒ Team leaders should also regularly check if their team members need any training to improve their skills. Training can be provided in two main ways:

1. Commercial training companies:

External companies that offer professional training.

Team members:

if someone on the team is good at using a particular tool or software, they can show others how to use it.

Staff Motivation

⇒ Some models of motivation are:

- o Maslow's hierarchy of needs
- o Expectancy theory of motivation

Maslow's hierarchy of needs

o Abraham Maslow proposed a hierarchy of needs.

o People have different needs that build on each other.

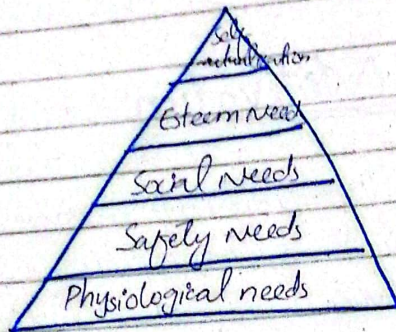
o Once basic needs are met, people focus on higher-level needs.

Example:

o At start people may be motivated by a salary increase.

As they mature and are already well-paid, they may care more

about things like autonomy (freedom in their work), which shows respect for their experience and responsibility.



Expectancy theory of motivation

⇒ Developed by VROOM.
 ⇒ Explains how people are motivated based on their expectations about their work and rewards.

• It focuses on three key factors:

Expectancy:-

• The belief that working harder will lead to better performance.

Instrumentality:-

• The belief that better performance will be rewarded.

perceived value:-

• of the resulting reward - like money, recognition or career growth.

⇒ The theory says that motivation depends on all three factors working together.

$$\text{Motivation} = \text{Expectancy} * \text{Instrumentality} * \text{Perceived value}$$

⇒ If any one of these factors is low, motivation will also be low.

Example:-

Stress

• Stress in projects often comes from trying to meet goals and overcome challenges.

• Both project managers and team members face pressure, and while some pressure is healthy, too much pressure can lead to lower work quality and even affect health.

⇒ Sometimes, extra effort and overtime are needed to get through temporary challenges or emergencies.

⇒ However, if overtime becomes a regular habit, it can lead to long-term problems.

⇒ Research shows that working more than 40 hours a week can cause a drop in productivity and the quality of the work.

Stress can come from several factors. Such as:

Role ambiguity:

When people don't clearly understand their job, what's expected of them, or their responsibilities, it creates confusion & stress.

Role conflict:

This conflict happens when someone is pulled in different directions by conflicting demands from different roles, making it hard to manage their tasks effectively.

Stress Management

⇒ Stress Management is important because while some stress can help people stay focused and productive, too much stress can cause problems.

⇒ When stress becomes overwhelming, it affects performance, emotions and even physical health.

Cognitive strains:

Stress can cause worrying, forgetfulness and difficulty concentrating.

Emotional strains:

Stress can lead to anxiety, restlessness, irritability and even anger.

Physical strains:

Stress might show up as headaches, fatigue, nausea, shallow breathing or back and shoulder pain.

In project management and software development, where people do intellectual work and have to meet customer demands and work with team, stress is common. When stress goes beyond a certain point, it's important to manage it. There are several techniques to reduce stress.

1. Imagery, relaxation & meditation
2. Cognitive Behavioral Approaches
3. Systematic approaches ⇒ changing the way of stress